

Business Analysis Techniques

A Comprehensive Guide to Strategic Problem Solving and Decision Making

7 CORE TECHNIQUES

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SWOT Analysis

A strategic framework to evaluate **Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats** — ideal for project kickoffs and business case reviews.



Example: Banking App Project

- **Strength:** Established brand trust and large customer base
- **Weakness:** Legacy systems slowing digital rollout
- **Opportunity:** Growing demand for mobile-first banking
- **Threat:** Rising cybersecurity risks and fintech competition

i SWOT works best when done collaboratively with stakeholders from multiple departments.

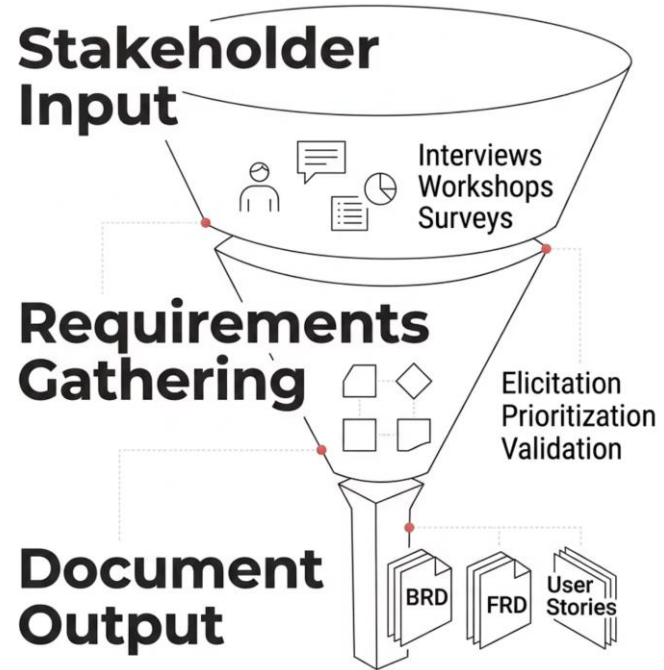
Requirements Analysis

What It Is

The process of **discovering, documenting, and validating** what stakeholders need from a system or solution — the foundation of every BA project.

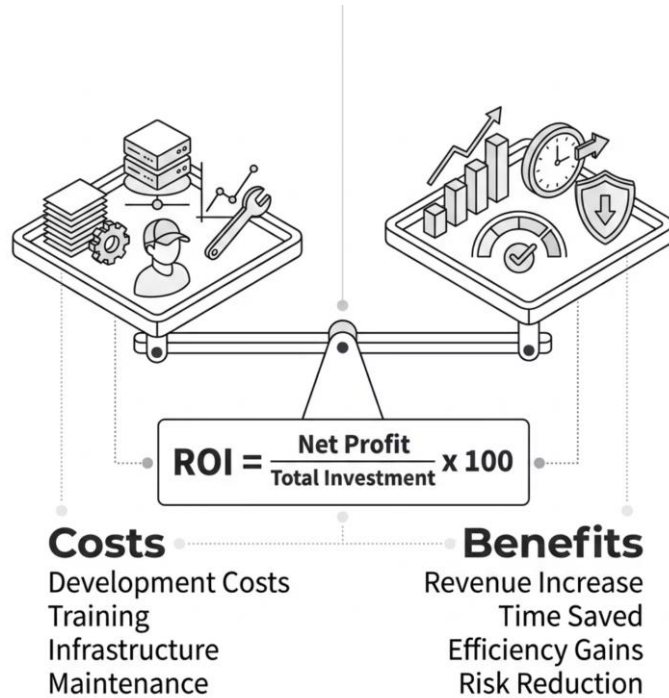
Key Tools

- **BRD** — Business Requirements Document
- **FRD** — Functional Requirements Document
- **User Stories** — Agile format: "As a... I want... So that..."



Cost-Benefit Analysis (CBA)

CBA quantifies whether a project's benefits outweigh its costs — a critical input for business case approval.



ROI Formula

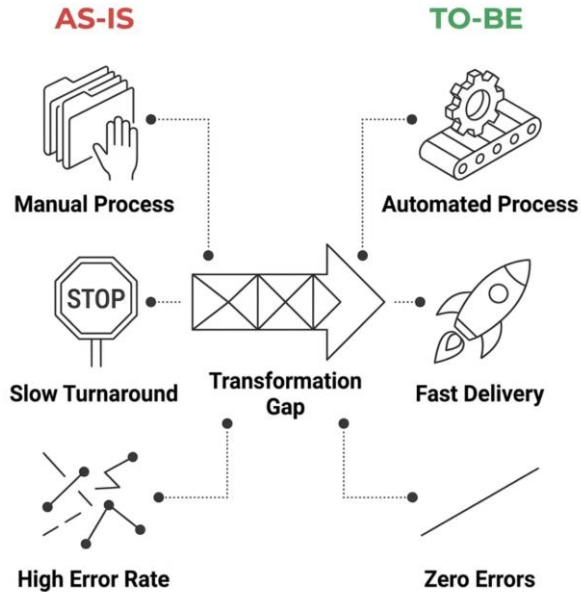
$$ROI = \frac{(\text{Benefits} - \text{Costs})}{\text{Costs}} \times 100$$

Decision Matrix

ROI Result	Decision
ROI > 0%	Proceed
ROI = 0%	Re-evaluate
ROI < 0%	Revise scope

Gap Analysis

Identify the difference between the current state and the desired future state — then define the steps to close that gap.



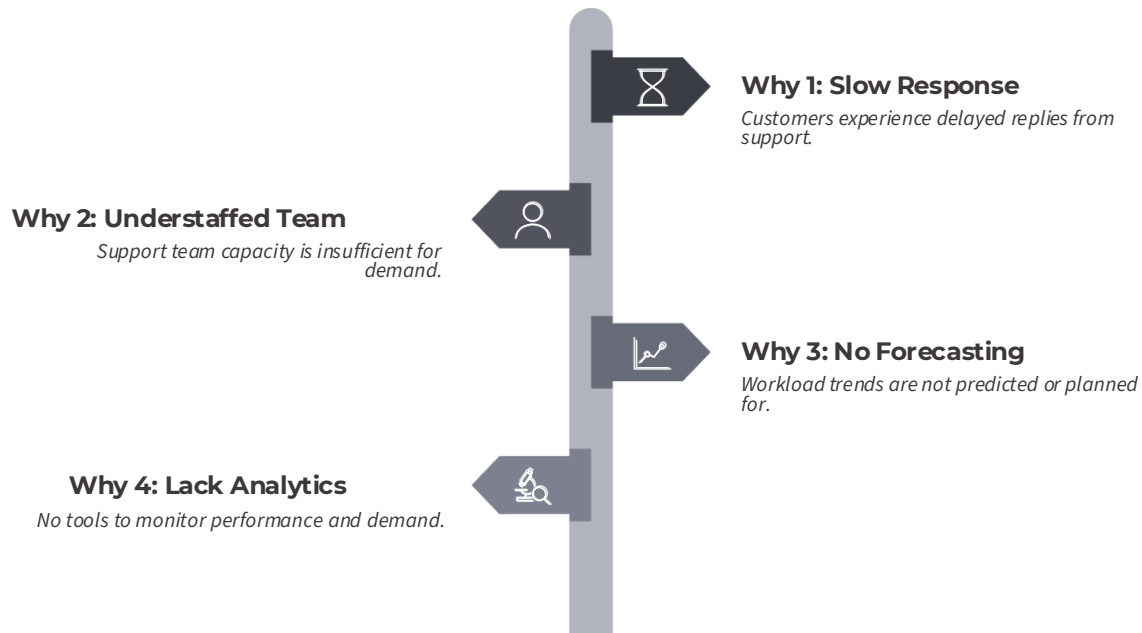
How to Conduct a Gap Analysis

1. Document the **current state** — processes, systems, and performance metrics
2. Define the **target state** — desired outcomes and success criteria
3. Identify **gaps** between the two states
4. Prioritize and **plan** remediation actions

i Gap Analysis is essential before any transformation initiative or system implementation.

Root Cause Analysis (RCA)

RCA digs beneath symptoms to find the **underlying cause** of a problem — preventing recurrence rather than applying quick fixes.



The 5 Whys method peels back layers of a problem by repeatedly asking "Why?" until the root cause is revealed.

5 Whys Method

Ask "Why?" iteratively until the fundamental cause surfaces. Simple and fast for straightforward problems.

Fishbone / Ishikawa Diagram

Organizes potential causes across 6 categories: **Man, Machine, Method, Material, Measurement, Environment**— ideal for complex, multi-factor problems.

Feasibility Analysis

Before committing resources, a **Feasibility Study** determines whether a project is viable across five critical dimensions.



Technical

Can the solution be built with available technology and skills?



Financial

Is the project cost-effective and within budget constraints?



Operational

Will the organization adopt and sustain the solution?



Legal

Does the project comply with regulations and contracts?



Time

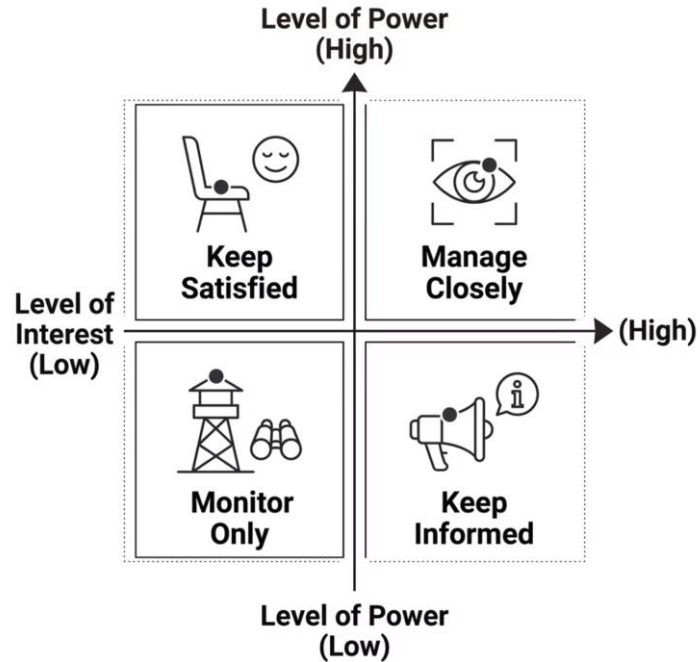
Can the project be completed within the required timeline?



Output: A **Feasibility Report** recommending Go / No-Go to decision-makers.

Stakeholder Analysis

Map stakeholders by power and interest to tailor engagement strategies and ensure the right voices are heard.



Engagement by Quadrant

- **Manage Closely** — High power, high interest; engage actively and frequently
- **Keep Satisfied** — High power, low interest; meet needs without over-communicating
- **Keep Informed** — Low power, high interest; provide regular updates
- **Monitor Only** — Low power, low interest; minimal effort required

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